ALUBONETS SELF-HELP GROUP

Website Upgrade Structure & Developer Guide

Functional Requirements • Member Hierarchy • Payments • Privacy • Resource Management

Purpose

To translate the group's updated governance, membership, finance and digital-transformation decisions into a clear implementation structure for the developer, while retaining the approved design direction in Design Blueprint v1.0.

Prepared for: Alubonets Self-Help Group
Reference: Vision/Constitution review document and SpectreTech Design Blueprint v1.0
Development target in blueprint: on or before 5 September 2026

1. Executive Development Brief

The upgraded platform should operate as two connected environments: a public-facing family website and a secure member portal. The public website should preserve the approved visual identity and public pages, while all sensitive family information, daily activities, payments, documents and internal resources should sit behind authenticated, role-based access.

Critical rule — A person cannot independently create a family branch or attach members. Only a Principal Member who has first been assigned that status by an Administrator may add family members under his/her branch.

2. Source-Aligned Objectives

- Centralize the family member database while preserving lineage and household relationships.
- Digitize contribution, payment and fund records for transparency and regular reporting.
- Provide a secure repository for constitutions, minutes, agreements, historical records and other approved documents.
- Provide member-only announcements, activities, events, welfare requests and communication resources.
- Support welfare, education, health, economic empowerment, community initiatives and other group projects.
- Use role-based permissions, account approval and security controls consistent with the blueprint direction.

3. Proposed Website Architecture

Area	Main Components	Access
Public Website	Home; About Us; Projects (public summary); Gallery (approved public images); Contact; Login	Anyone
Member Portal	Dashboard; Today's Activities; Family/Branch; Payments; Welfare; Events; Resources; Projects; Profile	Registered and approved members
Principal Member Workspace	Add/manage attached members; family branch; profile visibility permissions; branch payment view	Principal Member only
Committee/Officer Workspace	Role-specific finance, meetings, welfare, projects, documents, announcements and reports	Assigned office bearers/committee
Admin Console	Principal-member assignment; registration approval; users/roles; finance configuration; resources; audit	Administrator only

Area	Main Components	Access
	logs; settings	

4. User Roles and Permission Model

Role	Core Rights	Restrictions
Administrator	Approve/disable accounts; assign Principal Member status; assign roles; manage payment-purpose list; manage resources; configure access; view audit logs and system reports.	Should not bypass finance approval rules for disbursements merely because of system role.
Principal Member	Create/attach spouse, children and other approved members under own family branch; edit branch data; decide whether attached-member profiles are visible; view own branch payments and records.	Cannot create another Principal Member. Cannot move a member to another principal branch without admin-controlled transfer.
Attached Member (Adult)	Own login if registered/approved; view member-only activities/resources; make/record payments; view own eligible records; update permitted personal fields.	Cannot add members unless later assigned Principal Member by Admin. Profile visibility follows principal-member approval rule.
Child / Dependent	Stored under a Principal Member; may have no login by default; record can support lineage, education/welfare and age-based data.	No independent family management rights. Public/member-directory profile is hidden unless specifically allowed by Principal Member and permitted by age/privacy rules.
Office Bearer / Committee Role	Role-specific workflow: Treasurer, Secretary, Organizing Secretary, Executive/Committee, Auditor or other approved role.	Access limited to duties assigned; sensitive modules separated by least-privilege permissions.
Registered Member	Can access authenticated daily activities and member resources according to role.	Unregistered/public visitors cannot see internal daily activities.

5. Membership and Family Hierarchy

The core data model should be a family tree/branch structure anchored on the Principal Member. This is the most important change from a flat member directory.

Entity / Field	Developer Requirement
Principal Member	A normal member record with is_principal = true, assigned only by Administrator.
Attached Member	Every spouse, child or other approved family member must have principal_member_id linking them to one Principal Member.
Relationship	Required dropdown: spouse, son, daughter, child, dependent, other approved relationship. Prefer configurable values.
Member Status	Pending, Active, Inactive, Deceased, Resigned, Disqualified (status names can be finalized by the committee).
Registration State	Record-only / no login; invited; pending approval; registered/active account; suspended.
Lineage	Support branch/family lineage so the centralized registry can reflect family connections.
Profile Visibility	Principal profile may be displayed in the member directory. Attached-member profiles default to hidden; Principal Member can grant/revoke visibility.
Data Retention	Do not delete historical member records where finance, welfare, minutes or audit references exist; use status/archiving.

6. Membership Workflow

1. Administrator creates/approves a registered member and, where applicable, assigns the member as a Principal Member.
2. Only after Principal status is active does the “Add Family Member” action appear.
3. Principal Member selects relationship and enters the attached member’s details.
4. If the attached person needs a login, the Principal Member sends an invitation or requests registration; account activation remains subject to the configured approval process.
5. The system stores the Principal Member linkage permanently in the member history.
6. Any transfer from one Principal Member to another requires Administrator approval and must be written to the audit log.
7. For children/dependents, login is optional; their record remains under the Principal Member and can later transition to an adult account without creating a duplicate profile.

7. Profiles and Privacy Rules

Scenario	Required Behaviour
Principal Member directory card	Can be shown to registered members with approved fields such as name, branch, contacts/skills if permitted by data policy.
Attached adult member	Name/relationship may be mentioned under Principal Member. Full profile stays hidden by default.
Child/dependent	May be listed by name/relationship only where appropriate. No standalone profile unless Principal Member explicitly allows and the platform's child-data privacy setting permits it.
Visibility approval	Store visible_to_members boolean plus changed_by, changed_at and optional expiry/review date.
Public website	No detailed member directory. Family/member information is a private portal function.
Sensitive fields	Phone, email, date of birth, identity details, beneficiary details and finance data should not be exposed in directory views by default.

Privacy default — For attached members, especially children, use "hidden unless explicitly allowed" rather than "visible unless blocked".

8. Payments and Contributions Module

The constitution requires group money to be paid to the group bank account and emphasizes contribution records, member statements and financial reporting. The upgraded platform should therefore record and reconcile payments without presenting the website itself as the custodian of the funds unless a separately approved payment-gateway integration is implemented.

8.1 Payment Capture

Field	Requirement
Paying Member	Auto-filled from logged-in member; Admin/Treasurer may record on behalf of another member with audit trail.
Principal Branch	Derived automatically from principal_member_id for branch reporting.
Amount	KES amount, positive numeric value.

Field	Requirement
Purpose	Required dropdown managed by Admin/Treasurer.
Payment Method	Bank transfer, standing order, M-Pesa/paybill/till if later approved, cheque, or other approved method.
Reference	Bank/M-Pesa/transaction/reference number; unique where possible.
Payment Date	Date paid.
Proof	Optional/required upload according to method (receipt, bank slip, statement extract).
Verification Status	Pending, Verified, Rejected/Needs correction.
Verified By / Time	System audit fields.

8.2 Payment Purpose Dropdown

The dropdown should work like the current website payment structure but must be configurable instead of hard-coded. Initial categories can be set from the group's documented activities and constitution, then confirmed by the Treasurer/Committee.

Suggested Purpose	Notes
Registration Fee	Constitution currently states a non-refundable registration fee.
Annual Subscription / Contribution	Core member contribution.
Emergency / Welfare Fund	For emergency kitty/welfare support.
Funeral Support	Life-event welfare.
Wedding Support	Life-event welfare.
Dowry Support	Life-event welfare.
Medical Emergency	Health/welfare support.
Project / Investment Contribution	Approved group investment or project.
Education / Bursary Support	Education and capacity-building initiative.
Community / Charity Initiative	Approved external/community activity.

Suggested Purpose	Notes
Other Approved Purpose	Requires additional description.

Account configuration — The payment destination should be the official Alubonets group account approved by the group. The account details should be stored as an Administrator-controlled finance setting (with change history), not repeated/hard-coded across pages. The uploaded source does not expose a specific account number in the readable text, so the developer should obtain the confirmed account details from the Treasurer/Committee before production deployment.

8.3 Finance Dashboard & Controls

- Member contribution statement with filters by year, purpose and status.
- Principal Member branch summary showing own and attached-member payments, subject to privacy/finance rules.
- Treasurer reconciliation queue for pending payments.
- Monthly and annual contribution summaries; export to Excel/PDF.
- Welfare/emergency fund reporting and configurable allocation rules. The constitution currently references 20% emergency kitty and 80% reserve; implement this as a configurable rule so governance changes do not require code changes.
- No outgoing payment/disbursement should be marked approved without the required committee/member authorization workflow.
- Every finance edit, verification, reversal and export should be logged.

9. Activities, Events and Meetings

Feature	Requirement
Today's Activities	Visible only after successful member login and active registration status.
Calendar	Month/week/list view for meetings, welfare events, family activities, trainings and project events.
Activity Detail	Title, date/time, venue, organizer, description, attachments, audience, RSVP/attendance where needed.
Audience Control	All registered members; selected branch; committee; role; invited individuals.
Meeting Records	Link meeting agenda, minutes, attendance and resolutions to the event record.
Notifications	In-app notification; optional email/SMS/WhatsApp integrations can be added later.

10. Resource and Document Management

The website should manage the group's digital resources as a structured repository rather than a simple download page. This directly supports the vision of a common repository of records and the constitution's list of books/documents.

Resource Type	Examples	Access / Controls
Governance	Constitution, policies, operational guidelines, resolutions	Versioned; approved current version highlighted; restricted editing.
Meetings	Agendas, minutes, attendance, action trackers	Linked to meeting/event; committee uploads; member access as approved.
Finance	Annual reports, contribution summaries, budgets, audited statements	Treasurer uploads; member-readable reports; sensitive working files restricted.
Projects	Proposals, budgets, progress reports, photos, contracts	Project team/committee edit; member view based on project.
Welfare	Guidelines, forms, approved notices	Restricted where personal welfare details are involved.
Education/Health	Training materials, bursary resources, health information	Member resource library.
Historical Archive	Family history, agreements, approved photos/records	Metadata, categories, search, archive status.

10.1 Required Resource Features

- Folder/category and tag structure plus full-text/metadata search.
- Upload metadata: title, category, description, owner, date, version, visibility, related meeting/project, retention status.
- Role-based view/download/upload/edit/delete/archive permissions.
- Version history instead of overwriting important governance/finance documents.
- Preview common files where technically feasible; otherwise secure download.
- File size/type validation, malware scanning if supported, and safe filenames.
- Audit log for upload, replacement, download of sensitive resources and deletion/archive actions.
- Backups and a restore process.

11. Dashboard Structure

Dashboard	Recommended Widgets / Actions
Member	Today's activities; next event; payment status; latest notices; recent resources; welfare/project updates; family branch

Dashboard	Recommended Widgets / Actions
	link.
Principal Member	Branch member count; pending invitations; attached-member visibility controls; branch payments; upcoming family activities; add family member.
Treasurer	Collections this month/year; pending verification; arrears/expected contributions; purpose breakdown; bank-reconciliation queue; finance reports.
Secretary	Upcoming meetings; agenda/minutes workflow; notices; attendance; resolutions/action items; document repository.
Organizing Secretary	Activities/events; invitations; attendance; logistics; announcements; community engagements.
Admin	Member totals; Principal Members; pending registrations; roles/permissions; payment settings; resources; audit/security; system health.

12. Suggested Navigation

Public Navigation	Authenticated Member Navigation
Home	Dashboard
About Us	Today / Activities
Projects	My Family / Branch
Gallery	Payments & Statements
Contact Us	Welfare
Login / Member Portal	Events & Meetings
	Projects & Initiatives
	Resources / Documents
	Directory
	My Profile
	Notifications

13. Core Data Model

Table / Object	Important Fields
users	id, email/phone, password/auth provider, account_status, last_login, 2FA fields
members	id, user_id nullable, principal_member_id nullable, is_principal, relationship, names, DOB, contacts, branch/lineage, member_status, registration_date
profile_visibility	member_id, visible_to_members, allowed_fields, approved_by_principal_id, updated_at
roles / permissions	role, permission, scope, active dates
payments	member_id, principal_member_id, amount, purpose_id, method, reference, date, proof, verification_status, verified_by
payment_purposes	code, label, active, sort_order, accounting_category
fund_allocations	payment_id or period, fund bucket, percentage/amount, rule_version
activities / events	type, title, datetime, venue, audience, organizer, description, status
resources	title, category, file, version, visibility, owner, related_entity, archive status
projects	name, description, status, budget summary, dates, owners
welfare_requests	requester, beneficiary, category, amount/support, status, approvals, confidentiality level
audit_logs	actor, action, entity, old_value/new_value summary, timestamp, IP/device where appropriate

14. Key Business Rules / Acceptance Criteria

- Admin is the only role that can assign or remove Principal Member status.
- The “Add Member” function is unavailable to non-principal members.
- Every attached member must resolve to exactly one Principal Member at any point in time.
- Children/dependents are stored under a Principal Member and do not automatically receive login accounts.

- Attached-member profile pages are hidden by default and become visible only after Principal Member permission, subject to child/privacy restrictions.
- Unregistered or inactive users cannot view “Today’s Activities” or other private activity feeds.
- Every payment requires a purpose selected from the active dropdown list.
- Payment destination details are pulled from the active Alubonets finance setting.
- Payments can be verified/rejected only by authorized finance roles and each action is audited.
- Resources support category, visibility, version, search and access-control metadata.
- Important governance and finance documents cannot be permanently overwritten without version/history retention.
- Role-based access is enforced server-side, not only by hiding menu items in the browser.
- Authentication is production-ready before launch; the blueprint’s “any email/password” preview behavior must not remain in production.
- Mobile responsiveness and accessibility should be completed before production deployment, consistent with the blueprint’s stated plan.

15. Security and Data Protection Requirements

- Use secure authentication, password hashing, email/phone verification and optional/required two-factor authentication for privileged roles.
- Enforce least-privilege role permissions at API/backend level.
- Encrypt traffic using HTTPS; protect uploaded files with authorized access checks.
- Keep audit logs for member changes, role changes, profile-visibility changes, finance actions and document administration.
- Provide session timeout, account lock/rate limiting and secure password reset.
- Back up database and document storage; document restoration procedures.
- Avoid exposing member PII in public pages, URLs, logs or downloadable reports without authorization.
- For child/dependent information, collect only necessary data and default to restricted visibility.

16. Developer Implementation Priority

Phase	Priority Deliverables
P1 - Foundation	Authentication; member/Principal hierarchy; roles/permissions; audit logging; database migrations.
P2 - Member Experience	Member dashboard; family branch; profile privacy; Today’s Activities; directory.
P3 - Finance	Payment settings/account display; purpose dropdown; payment capture; verification; statements; reports.
P4 - Resources & Governance	Document repository; meetings/minutes; announcements; events/calendar; versioning.
P5 - Welfare/Projects	Welfare requests; project tracking; education/health/community resource areas.
P6 - QA & Launch	Responsive design; accessibility; security testing;

Phase	Priority Deliverables
	backup/restore test; UAT; production deployment.

17. Decisions the Developer Should Confirm Before Coding

- Exact official Alubonets account name/number/payment channel to display and who is authorized to change it.
- Final list of payment purposes and whether any purpose has a fixed amount or due date.
- Whether attached adult members can independently pay and view statements, or whether all branch payments are managed through the Principal Member.
- Which attached-member fields may be shown when a Principal Member grants profile visibility.
- At what age a child/dependent can receive an independent login and whether the Principal Member relationship remains visible after that transition.
- Final office-bearer roles and each role's permission matrix.
- Which documents are visible to all registered members versus committee-only.
- Whether the constitutional 20% emergency / 80% reserve rule remains current and should be automated.
- Whether welfare approvals require a digital workflow and the number/roles of approvers.
- Whether integrations are required now (M-Pesa, bank, email, SMS, WhatsApp) or in a later phase.

18. Notes Against the Existing Blueprint

The blueprint already establishes the public pages, an Admin Dashboard structure, and a design system using Deep Navy (#083378), Orange (#F07602), Dark Navy (#142033), and an off-white neutral background, with Sora/Inter typography. The new requirements above should be implemented within that visual direction rather than treated as a redesign.

Blueprint Item	Upgrade Guidance
Home / About / Projects / Gallery / Contact	Retain as public pages, but ensure private family activities and member records do not leak into public content.
Admin Dashboard	Extend member management to support Admin-assigned Principal Members and branch relationships.
Contributions / Finance modules	Add payment-purpose dropdown, official account settings, reconciliation, member statements and fund reporting.
Events	Separate public events (if any) from private daily/member activities.
Documents	Expand to full resource repository with permissions, categories, versions and audit history.
Roles & Permissions	Implement granular backend enforcement for Admin, Principal Member, office bearers, committee and normal

Blueprint Item	Upgrade Guidance
	members.
Authentication	Replace preview-only login behavior with approved registration, secure authentication, role-based access and 2FA for privileged accounts.

19. Final Developer Handover Summary

Build around the family branch — The central implementation model is: Administrator → Principal Member → Attached Members/Children. Payments, profiles, activities and resources should respect this hierarchy and the role/visibility rules attached to it.

This guide should be used alongside the Design Blueprint v1.0 and the Alubonets vision/constitution material. Where a functional rule in this guide requires a governance decision (for example exact finance allocation, profile fields or age thresholds), the developer should make it configurable and obtain committee confirmation rather than embedding an assumption in code.